

Flexible fins

The mudskipper is an unusual fish that lives in mangrove swamps. It can breathe in air, and it can also "skip" and climb to catch its food. Mudskippers skip by flicking their tails. They climb by using fins that work like suckers and others that are like stubby legs.



Bright stripes revealed during mid-jump

Toes spread out to increase surface area

Front feet angle to touch down before back ones when frog lands

Flash of color when frog jumps startles predators, giving frog time to escape



Tree-climbing crab

The coconut crab is a climber with a leg span of around 3 ft (1 m). It hauls its massive body up coconut trees to reach nuts that are still soft and unripe. It uses its legs to grip the tree trunk while its claws cut into the fruit.

Leaps and bounds

For their size, the world's best jumpers are fleas. They can leap more than 12 in (30 cm), which is about 200 times their body length. Human athletes can manage around 29 ft (9 m), but the record jumpers are large kangaroos and snow leopards. They can leap more than 42 ft (13 m) on level ground.

